

Congress MP from Mumbai North who is notorious as an actor too for late arrivals for Bollywood shoots, attended for just 38 days (*see box*).

The CPI(M) MP who was worried about non-availability of masala dosas on south-bound trains is not alone. Members cutting across the party divide make a mockery of serious debate. The din at Question Hour is often deafening and the larger parties use their collective vocal power to drown serious business. The Left parties, which have been pilloried for holding the Government to ransom for much of the last four years, have one major contribution—they forced the Government to bring foreign policy debate back to the House.

Amidst the gloom, there were a few rays of hope. There were members who took their responsibilities as seriously as they took their privileges. Among them Anandrao Vithoba Adsul (Shiv Sena, Buldhana, Maharashtra) Shivaji Adhalrao Patil (Shiv Sena, Ked, Maharashtra), S.K. Kharventhan (INC, Palani), Sugrib Singh (BJD, Phulbani, Orissa), Ravi Prakash Verma (SP, Kheri, Uttar Pradesh) Braja Kishore Tripathi (BJD, Puri, Orissa) lead the list

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of those who raised maximum number of questions. Those with maximum attendance include Devendra Prasad Yadav, RJD MP from Jharkhand (294 days); Thokchom Meinza, Congress MP from Inner Manipur (293 days). The statutes provide for a member of Parliament to be disqualified if absent for 20 days without prior consent, but party whips always ensure that habitual absentees sign on the 20th day.

Nothing has left as dark a stain on Parliament's reputation as that July

A Question of ANSWERS

The perseverance of some members gives hope

Anandrao Vithoba Adsul



Constituency
Buldhana,
Maharashtra
Party Shiv Sena
Questions asked
1,255

Shivaji Adhalrao Patil



Constituency
Khed,
Maharashtra
Party Shiv Sena
Questions asked
1,251

S. K. Kharventhan



Constituency
Palani,
Tamil Nadu
Party Congress
Questions asked
1,108

Sugrib Singh



Constituency
Phulbani,
Orissa
Party BJD
Questions asked
1,083

Ravi Prakash Verma



Constituency
Kheri, Uttar
Pradesh
Party SP
Questions asked
1,050

Braja Kishore Tripathy



Constituency
Puri,
Orissa
Party BJD
Questions asked
1,048

No question ABOUT IT

Some senior members seemed content in the anonymity of the back benches

Ajit Singh



Constituency
Baghpat,
Uttar Pradesh
Party RLD
Questions raised
0

Jagdish Tytler



Constituency
Delhi Sadar,
Delhi
Party Congress
Questions raised
0

K.V Thangka Balu



Constituency
Salem,
Tamil Nadu
Party Congress
Questions raised
0

Kalyan Singh



Constituency
Bulandshahr,
Uttar Pradesh
Party BJP
Questions raised
0